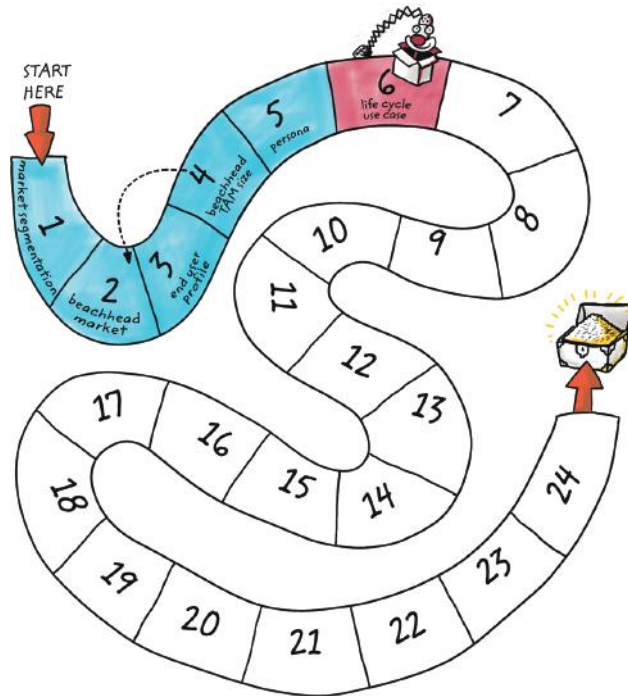


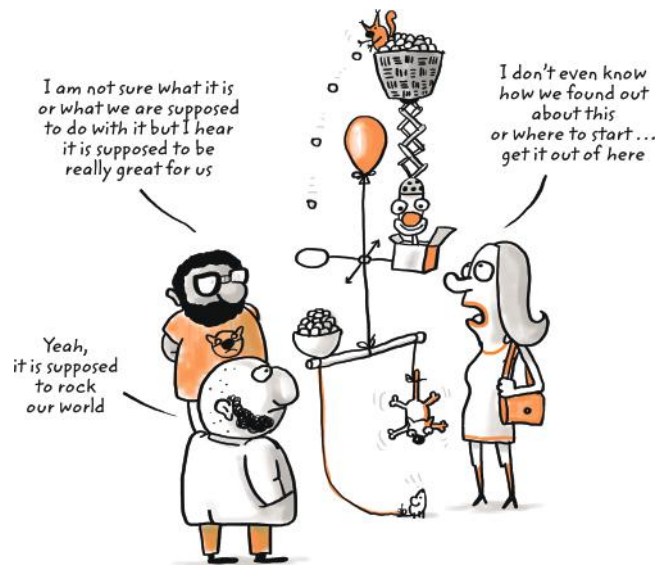
STEP 6

Full Life Cycle Use Case



IN THIS STEP, YOU WILL:

- Describe in detail how your Persona finds out about your product, acquires it, uses it, gets value from it, pays for it, and buys more and/or tells others about it.
- Understand why this expanded use case is important to identify and resolve problems in the most timely and cost-effective manner.
- Gain additional clarity and alignment throughout your team by detailing the various aspects of the Full Life Cycle Use Case.



Building a Full Life Cycle Use Case further focuses the discussion on what specifically your product will do for your customer . . . and what your customer will do with it.

Now that you have assembled great specificity about your end user and are focused on your target customer, you have to collect equally specific details about how this person will use the product. You will construct a use case, but your use case will be more expansive than the traditional definition.

You must determine how your product fits into your Persona's value chain. What are the key interface points? Why exactly would customers want to acquire the product? What barriers to adoption might arise? The Full Life Cycle Use Case should include not just how the customer would use the product, but also the acquisition (including the payment for the product) and post-installation support processes. To fully complete the analysis, it would be extremely valuable to understand if and when the user would purchase your product again.

Rather than simply describing how your Persona will use your product, you should also detail how the end user determines they have a need for your product. Then determine how they acquire your product and ultimately how you will get paid for your product. You will start by mapping out the process from beginning to end for your Persona and then check to see if it is consistent with other potential customers as well. The easiest way to start is by mapping out how your Persona uses the product once it is acquired. From there, map out the acquisition and post-acquisition support cases.

Once again, you will be using primary market research. It is imperative in this process that you see your product through the eyes of the customer and not through your eyes. When entrepreneurs see the Full Life Cycle Use Case through their own eyes, they tend to overestimate many things. First of all, they overestimate the enthusiasm the customer has for their product. Also, they are often overconfident regarding what the customer will gain from using their product and how easy it will be to use. This type of Full Life Cycle Use Case is often fictional and misses the fact that the user has many competing priorities and may not be particularly interested in taking on risk by integrating a new product from a new company into their value chain. Without doing a complete Full Life Cycle Use Case, you will not notice any problems until your order volume decreases and you are scrambling to gain first-time and repeat customers.

WHAT TO INCLUDE IN A FULL LIFE CYCLE USE CASE

The Full Life Cycle Use Case should first explain how the Persona determines that their existing needs are not being met by existing products, and how the Persona would find out about your product. Since you have been doing extensive primary market research, your Persona likely found out about the product through the course of your research, so you should instead detail how your Persona would have heard about the product if they had been a completely new prospect.

It is helpful to outline the customer's current workflow, because by knowing the customer's current process, it is easier to integrate your product into their operation. Customers who are generally satisfied with their workflow will rarely want to radically overhaul their process even if your product provides benefits over their current system.

The following factors are all essential parts of the Full Life Cycle Use Case:

1. How end users will determine they have a need and/or opportunity to do something different.
2. How they will find out about your product.
3. How they will analyze your product.
4. How they will acquire your product.
5. How they will install your product.
6. How they will use your product (in detail; see the Satisfier example further on).
7. How they will determine the value gained from your product.
8. How they will pay for your product.
9. How they will receive support for your product.
10. How they will buy more product and/or spread awareness (hopefully positive) about your product.

The Full Life Cycle Use Case should be visual, using diagrams, flowcharts, or other methods that show sequence.

EXAMPLES

The “How Will They Use Your Product” Section of a Use Case: Satisfier

The hospitality industry lives and dies by the quality of their customer service. From hotels to restaurants to entertainment venues, the sales and profit of a location fall quickly if customers are not happy when they leave. Regional managers with many locations to oversee have their issues compounded because they need to guarantee the satisfaction of a large number of customers. Regional managers are constantly looking for tools to more accurately and rapidly measure customer satisfaction for their specific environments.

Toward this end, one student team had an idea to take advantage of the increasingly ubiquitous nature of smartphones to provide real-time survey feedback for businesses. After their primary market research, they determined that the quickest and most capital-efficient way to get their company off the ground would be targeting a specific group of food service companies that served universities. The team's idea was to create posters with a picture of the food offerings available on that day and put it at the exit of the eating establishment. Under each picture were two QR (Quick Response) codes that allowed the consumer to easily register either their approval or disapproval of a food option. In such a scenario, the food service companies could get instant feedback on their menu. The student team prepared a mini-use case (Figure 6.1), detailing how the customer would use their product.



Figure 6.1 Satisfier use case.

This is an easily understood segment of the Full Life Cycle Use Case that can be presented to potential end customers for feedback. The team has thought through how its product would be used by the customer to create value. The example forced them to be specific about many things that can otherwise be glossed over. They incorporated not just what their product was (from Step 7) and who the Persona was (from Step 5), but now they could detail how everything interacted and how the entire story would play out. They learned about key people and roles they needed to consider. It generated common understanding and alignment throughout the team regarding the problem being solved and how their product solved it.

Such a use case might seem obvious, but it is much harder than teams anticipate and it is always a valuable touch point as you go forward. This use case, while helpful, is incomplete in that it leaves out many of the early elements (How did your customer find out about your product and then decide to bring it in for a test?) and the later elements (How does the customer pay for your product, get service for it, and ultimately help generate a following for your business by buying more products and/or generating word of mouth for your company?). However this is where most companies begin and then build out the front and back ends.

A More Robust Use Case: FillBee

Another student team was looking to revolutionize the furniture shopping experience by making it possible to see what any combination of furniture in your home would look like before you buy it. Through a sophisticated 3D rendering platform that took in the dimensions of your house or apartment, a 3D world would be created where the user could use a computer to try out different pieces of furniture before purchase. Conceptually it sounded great, but what often works conceptually does not work in reality.

Fillbee started its use case development by mapping the Persona's perspective on how they currently shop for furniture.

A primary pain point in the furniture acquisition process—that the furniture sometimes does not fit in the user's home and has to be returned—is shown clearly in Figure 6.2. To arrive at this point, they went through many visual iterations with a multidisciplinary team. Working backward, FillBee identified “research + plan” as the step where improvements can be made regarding measuring rooms and furniture. FillBee's product also condenses certain steps, such as condensing “research + plan,” “browse,” and “buy” into one online process rather than a combination in-person/online process.



FILLBEE PRESENTATION DECK

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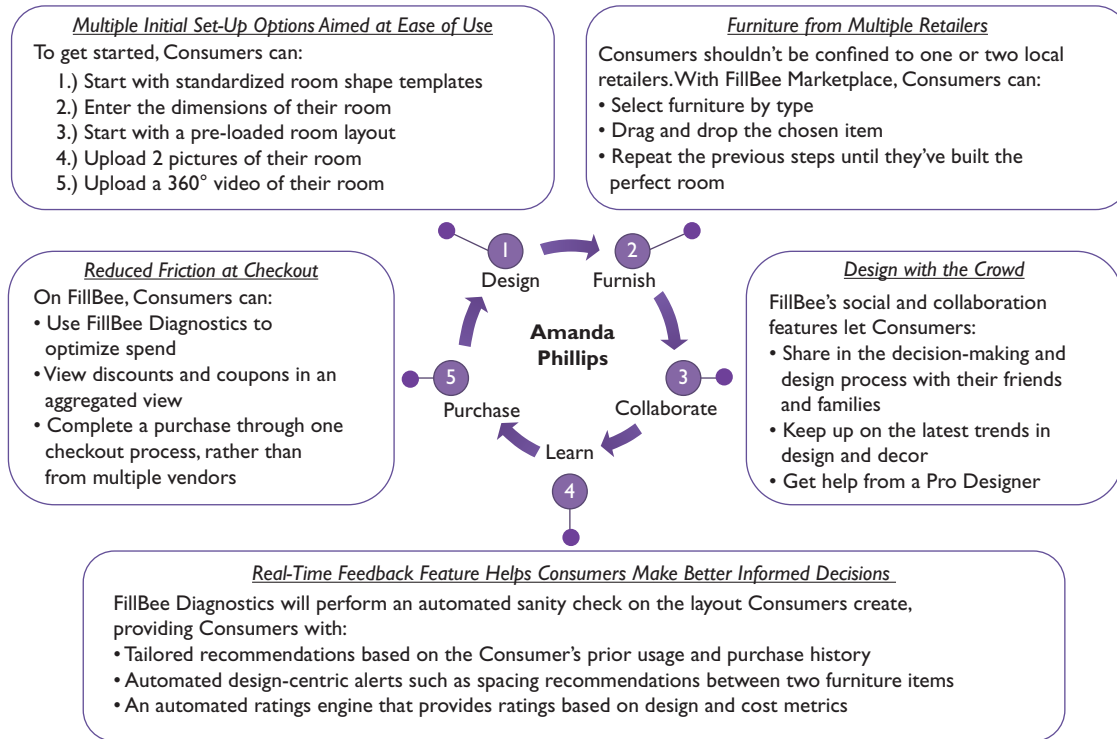


Figure 6.3 FillBee's Amanda Phillips Use Case; good but still missing some upfront and backend elements.

SUMMARY

Creating a visual representation of the full life cycle of your product enables you to see how the product will fit into the customer's value chain and what barriers to adoption might arise. Just showing how the customer uses the product (the typical definition of "use case") will not provide an accurate enough picture to fully understand what obstacles will come up when trying to sell your product to your target customer.